December rather than the previously announced 15 December deadline.

The third, S.O. 3409(E), notified the new ₹2,000 banknote as legal currency under Section 24(2) of the RBI Act. However, someone had not done his homework. This was the wrong section as the government gives the RBI the authority to issue banknotes under Section 24(1). So, this had to be changed the next day!

In S.O. 3410(E), banks were instructed to submit reports listing the amount they held in demonetized notes. This notification also had to be amended the next day, because the names of SBI and several cooperative banks and nationalized banks had been omitted.

Meanwhile, the rules for the exchanging and depositing of demonetized notes were amended repeatedly. The upper limit on how much money could be exchanged in a day was frequently changed causing confusion in the minds of both citizens and bank staff. It started initially at ₹4,000, then went up to ₹4,500 for three days, then dropped down to ₹2,000, and then finally the option to exchange money was removed completely.

The proposal to raise the limits on cash withdrawal from ATMs had to be scrapped because of the slow pace at which ATMs were being recalibrated.

Spokespersons of the government tried to justify these frequent amendments as proof of the sensitivity of a responsive administration to citizens' feedback. Lamentably, even a cursory reading of the notifications shows that they were simply not thought through, and the reversals and amendments were often no more than knee-jerk responses to public anger and ridicule.

On 14 November, five days after demonetization, all DCCBs were banned from accepting deposits of the banned currency notes due to the fear that black money would be laundered through this route. This move caused widespread distress in rural areas. Farmers across the country who had just sold their kharif crop were holding cash in the demonetized 1,000 and 500 notes. Unable to deposit their hard-